SABSA®

An overview of the SABSA Methodology

What is SABSA?

Sherwood Applied Business Security Architecture

- The world's leading free-use and open-source security architecture development and management method
- Methodology for developing business-driven, risk and opportunity focused enterprise security & information assurance architectures, and for delivering security infrastructure & service management solutions that **traceably** support critical business initiatives
- Development, maintenance, certification and accreditation is governed by the SABSA Institute

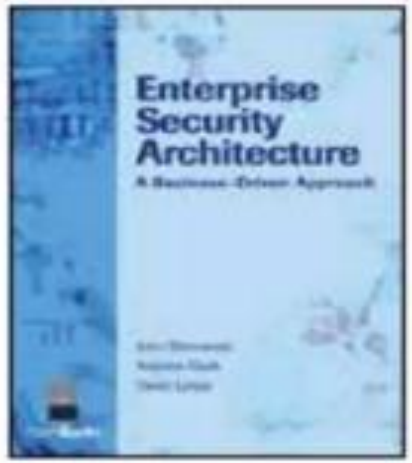
What is SABSA?

Sherwood Applied Business Security Architecture

- Comprised of a number of integrated frameworks, models, methods and processes, including:
  - Business Requirements Engineering Framework (also known as Attributes Profiling)
  - Risk & Opportunity Management Framework
  - Policy Architecture Framework
  - Security Services-Oriented Architecture Framework
  - Governance Framework
  - Security Domain Framework
  - Through-life Security Service & Performance Management

What is SABSA?

SABSA History & Development



- White Paper originally authored by John Sherwood 1995
- First use in global financial messaging (S.W.I.F.T.net) 1995
- SABSA Textbook (CMP / Elsevier version) by John Sherwood, Andrew Clark & David Lynas, 2005
  - "Enterprise Security Architecture: A Business-driven Approach"
  - ISBN 1-57820-318-X
- Adopted as UK MoD Information Assurance Standard 2007
- Certification programme introduced March 2007

Why is SABSA So Successful?

SABSA INSTITUTE

Institute Status

- In UK "Institute" has a protected and highly-regulated status
- SABSA Institute is a formal non-profit 'Community-of-Interest' Corporation
  - SABSA Intellectual Property can never be sold
  - Underwrites free-use status in perpetuity
  - Guarantees protected on-going development
  - Independently certifies & accredits SABSA Architects to provide confidence & assurance to industry, government & the professional community

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Why is SABSA So Successful?

Features & Advantages Summary

FEATURE	ADVANTAGE
Business-driven	Value-assured
Risk-focused	Prioritised & proportional responses
Comprehensive	Scalable scope
Modular	Agility - ease of implementation & management
Open Source (protected)	Free use, open source, global standard
Auditable	Demonstrates compliance
Transparent	Two-way traceability

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Why is SABSA So Successful?

Unique Selling Points & "Elevator Pitches"

- Each of the seven primary features and advantages can be interpreted and customised into key "elevator pitch" messages and unique selling points (USPs) for specific stakeholders or customers
- There is a case study example created for eight stakeholders / job titles at a global bank in the reference document "SABSA Features, Advantages & Benefits Summary"

Why is SABSA So Successful?

Competency-based Professional Certification

- Real 'professionals' (such as pilots and doctors) are not certified by their professional body based on knowledge
  - They are required to demonstrate application of skill
  - Career progression is achieved by 'doing' not 'knowing'
- Certification by the SABSA Institute is competency-based
- It delivers to stakeholders the assurance, trust and confidence that a professional has demonstrated the skill and ability to use the SABSA method in the real world

How is SABSA Used?

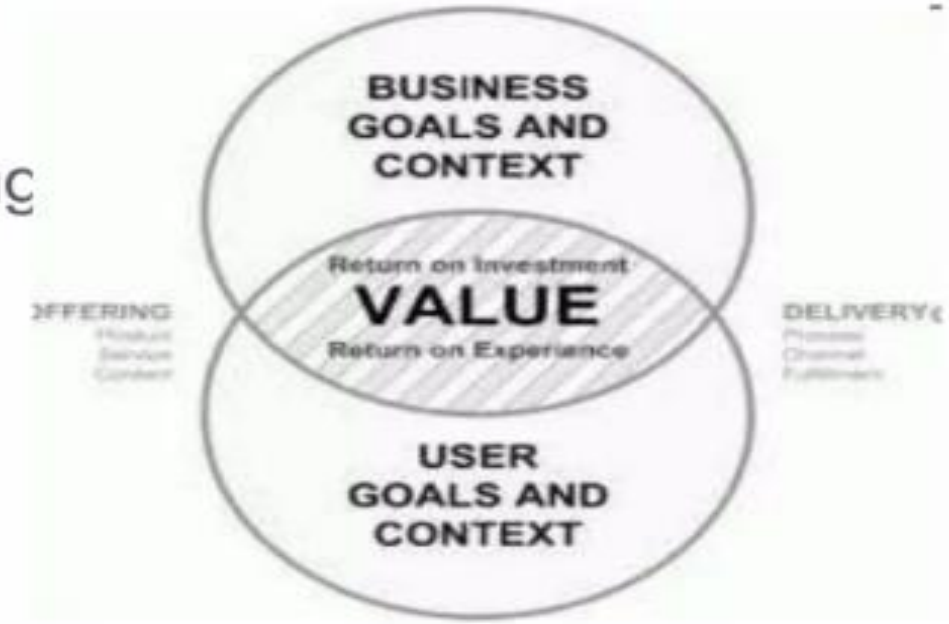
Applications of SABSA

- Enterprise Security Architecture
- Enterprise Architecture
- Individual solutions-based Architectures
- Seamless security integration & alignment with other frameworks (including TOGAF, ITIL, ISO27000 series, Zachman, DoDAF, CobIT, NIST, etc.)
- Filling the security architecture and security service management gaps in other frameworks

How is SABSA Used?

Applications of SABSA

- Business requirements engineering
- Solutions traceability
- Risk & Opportunity Management
- Information Assurance
- Governance, Compliance & Audit
- Policy Architecture



How is SABSA Used?

Applications of SABSA

- Security service management
- IT Service management
- Security performance management, measures & metrics
- Service performance management, measures & metrics
- Over-arching decision-making framework for end-to-end solutions

Who Uses SABSA?

SABSA User Base

- As SABSA is free-use and registration is not required, we do not have a definitive list of user organisations
- However, we do know the profiles of the thousands of professionals who have qualified as SABSA Chartered Architects
- There are SABSA Chartered Architects at Foundation Level (SCF) in more than 50 countries, on every continent, and from every imaginable business sector

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